

General Lit.





About the Course

Continue fostering independence and a love of reading with irresistible stories such as *The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe* and historical fiction from the time period.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 4

About Literature: Grade 4

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.



Placement & Combining Tips

About Literature: Grade 4

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

General Lit.: Grade 4

Suitable for Grades 5-6 if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
4	General Lit.: Grade 4 1 time/week 20 min	<i>The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe</i> <i>Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates</i>

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 4				
	General Lit.: Grade 4		Mythology/Hist. Fiction: Grade 4	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grade 4

☐ Although these books also make for great read-alouds, they were specifically chosen to help students to begin transitioning toward independence and continue growing in reading fluency and ease. While lesson plans are intended to be achievable during the lesson times on average,

reading speed varies widely at this age. Focus on having students read for the time allotted, more than getting through the exact section assigned.

☐ Ask students to recall what happened last before sending them to read the day's selection on their own. Oral narrations can be completed into a voice recorder or back with a parent or class. These are also great books to use for occasional written narrations.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

General Lit.: Grade 4

☐ If students have already read *The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe*, consider having them still read it on their own if it might help them gain confidence reading and completing lessons themselves. Otherwise, substitute another book in the Narnia series or substitute with a book from an adjacent grade's literature lessons and begin *Johnny Tremain* earlier in the year (the whole book is too long to finish before the end of Term 3, so it can easily be moved back).

☐ For the *Silver Skates*, we have provided two different pacing options for the book depending on your student(s) and context. The first pacing option is slower and better suited for less confident readers reading independently OR those reading the book aloud with their student(s). Note that students will want to finish this book on their own time after the end of the year.

The second pacing option moves more quickly and allows students to finish the book. This is best suited to quick readers or those who want to assign any reading not finished in a lesson for students to complete as homework on their own time during the term.

Regardless of which pacing option you choose, be sure to leave time for students to narrate at the end of the lesson. Note that recap and discussion questions are based on the slower pacing so feel free to skip ahead and use a discussion question from a different lesson if you're following the faster option.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grade 4



The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



General Lit.: Grade 4

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students start reading independently (General Literature selections are especially good for independent work).



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them an illustration, sharing something that the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas

in the manner most natural to them.

- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time might be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 1

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ INTRO

Starting in Grades 3-4, more and more of our literature books will also relate to the historical time period we're studying in history courses. But some books are just beautiful and interesting stories to enjoy. Based on the title, do you have any guesses on what The Lion, the Witch, and the Wardrobe will be about?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 2

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 3

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last? Do you remember the names of the four children?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 4

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 5

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ INTRO

Which character do you relate to most so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 6

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.6

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 7

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP**
Describe each of the four children.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.7

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 8

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP**
What happened last?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.8

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 9

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP**
Describe your favorite "supporting" character (i.e., not one of the main characters like Edmund, Aslan, etc.).

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.9

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 10

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP**
What happened last?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.10

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 11

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ **RECAP**
What do you think will happen next?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.11

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**
Answer question(s) related to the course.

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or
scan the QR code
for links.](#)



Term 1

Questions will come from:
The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 13

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What's currently happening in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 14

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Who is your favorite character in the book now? Has it changed from a few months ago or stayed the same?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 15

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe the White Witch.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 16

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

Describe Aslan.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 17

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP

What happened last?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 18

Materials: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe

→ RECAP, READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17

- What did you think of the end of the story?

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 19

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ INTRO

Following the Civil War, the American public was in dire need of a pleasant distraction. Hans Brinker offered this escape and became an instant bestseller, second only to Charles Dickens in sales. Mary Mapes Dodge made a lasting change in children's literature both as the author of Hans Brinker and editor of St. Nicholas magazine. She brought some of the finest writers of her day to young readers and helped make writing for children lively, thoughtful, and full of imagination.

This story is set in Holland. The Netherlands is the official name of the entire country, while Holland makes up two provinces within the country - North and South Holland. Optional: View Holland on this map. (Scroll down to see the map.)

∞ Map Link: The Netherlands

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2

OR

Ch.1-3

- What have you already learned about Holland?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Choose which pacing option to follow based on the ability and interest of your student(s). See Planning & Prep notes for more details on each option.

• TERMINOLOGY

∞ **Article Link:** Hans Brinker Pronunciation & Corrections (shared with permission)

• EXTRA HELPING

Click "See More" near the top of this page to read a short bio of the author.

∞ **Article Link:** Mary Mapes Dodge Bio

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 20

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Amsterdam, the capital city of the Netherlands. You may want to print the map and tuck it in the book to refer to as you read.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4

OR

Ch.4-6

- How would you describe Hans and Gretel to a friend?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Dutch Windmill Inside

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 21

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did Hans and Gretel find a friend?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-7

OR

Ch.7-9

- What "shadows" hang over the Brinker home?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ **Video Link:** Traditional Dutch Winter Skating

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 22

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Hans and Gretel's parents?

• LITERATURE CONNECTION

Louisa May Alcott (of Little Women fame) wrote for the St. Nicholas magazine!



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.8-9 OR Ch.10-11 • What does the boys’ plan to skate nearly fifty miles reveal about them and the time they live in? → VIEW St. Nicholas illustration from St. Nicholas magazine, where Mary Mapes Dodge served as editor. ∞ Image Link: St. Nicholas Illustration		
WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 23 📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates	→ RECAP What do you think will happen next? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.10-11 OR Ch.12-15 • How do Dutch customs of the Saint Nicholas celebration compare to your own Christmas celebrations?	• EXTRA HELPING Virtually browse some of the art mentioned in this chapter if time allows. ∞ Link: Rijksmuseum Art
WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 24 Exam Week	→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe	

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 25

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Saint Nicholas celebrations?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13

OR

Ch.16-18

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Haarlem.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How would you have responded to the "catastrophe" if you had been with the boys?

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 26

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened in the catastrophe? What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-15

OR

Ch.19-21

- What different kinds of homes are described?
- Why does Gretel struggle with her feelings about her father?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Historic Dutch Home Tour

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 27

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Brinker home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-17

OR

Ch.22-23

- Why do you think the author includes so many details about the places the boys visit?

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 28

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What was the meaning of the "man with four heads"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18-19

OR

Ch.24-26

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Can a Finger Really be Used to Stop a Leaky Dike?

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- What dangers or freedoms come with spending so much time on the ice?

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 29

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened last on the canal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20-21

OR

Ch.27-28

- How do group plans reveal who is flexible, selfish, cautious, or brave?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The next lesson includes an optional video for traditional Dutch gingerbread (a five-ingredient quick bread). Look ahead and gather ingredients if you would like to make your own.

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 30

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Red Lion so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-23

OR

Ch.29-32

- How does the author mix comedy and danger? Why do you think she chose to do that?

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn how to make traditional Dutch gingerbread.

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Gingerbread

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 31

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did the Red Lion become dangerous? What was the resolution?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-25

OR

Ch.33-36

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Leiden (Leyden is an older spelling).

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How can visiting museums help us better understand the people, history, and culture of a place?

• EXTRA HELPING

The "Egyptian Museum" is likely the Rijksmuseum van Oudheden.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum van Oudheden

General Lit.: Grade 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 32

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What did the boys see in Leyden?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27

OR

Ch.37-40

- How does the quote “it is no sin to love beautiful things if you adapt your material to circumstances” help us think about enjoying beauty wisely?

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 33

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What stories were shared in the last lesson?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29

OR

Ch.41-42

→ MAP WORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find The Hague.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- Why is a day of rest important in the story?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Hague Market Today

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 34

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened during the visit to The Hague?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30-31

OR

Ch.43-44

- As they head home, what has changed because of their journey?

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 35

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened as the boys headed home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32-33

OR

Ch.45-48

- Why is it sometimes difficult to hope when a situation feels uncertain?
- How can friendship help someone going through tough times?



Term 3

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grade 4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ READ & DISCUSS

Ch.34-35
OR
Finish the book over exam week as needed.

• EXTRA HELPING
∞ **Article Link:** Elfstedentocht:
The Famed Frozen Race

General Lit.: Grade 4

Examination

- Term 1** · The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe: Who is your favorite character in the book? Why?
- Term 2** · The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe: What did you think of the end of the book?
- Term 3** · Hans Brinker: Explain two ways that Hans and Gretel show responsibility and care for their family. What do their actions tell us about the kind of people they are? OR Describe two places the boys visit during their trip and explain what they see or experience at each one.